Universität Münster

MÜNSTER IMAGING NETWORK
- Microscopy -

MetaFold

Template-Driven Desktop Tool to Sync, Enrich, and Automate Your Research Data

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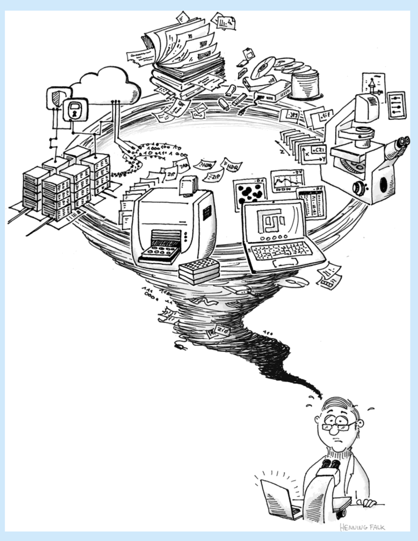
Research Data Management (**RDM**) is essential for ensuring data reusability and compliance with the **FAIR principle.** Yet in everyday research practice, **metadata annotation** (essential "data about data" that describes, for example, experimental conditions, analysis settings, or knowledge annotations) is often **overlooked**, as researchers **rarely** enrich their data with sufficient metadata. Existing tools are perceived as **complex and time-consuming**, offering little immediate benefit. **MetaFold** addresses this challenge with a **simple, template-based** desktop application that makes RDM compliance as **intuitive** as creating a new local folder. By capturing rich metadata directly at the point of data creation, **MetaFold** turns proper data management from an afterthought into an effortless part of the research workflow.

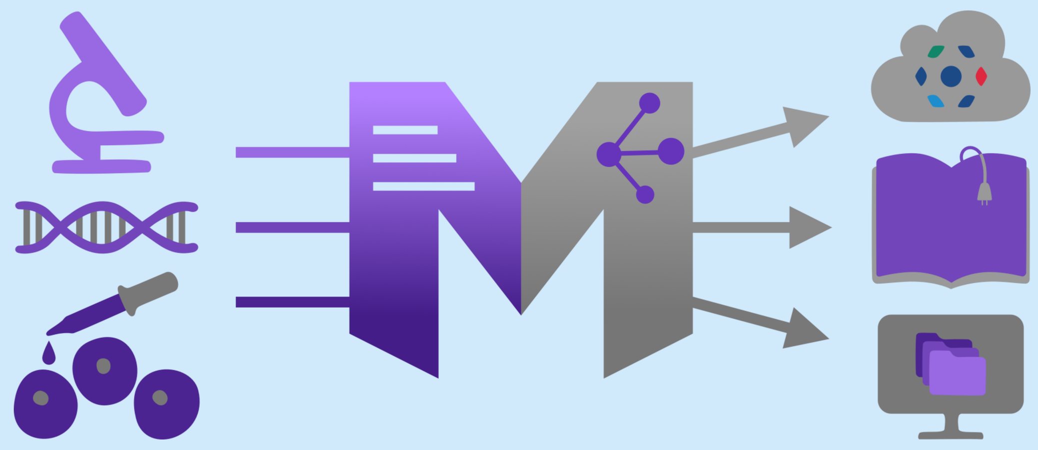
❌ The Metadata gap

- Too many and too complex tools, detached from daily workflows.
- RDM feels like extra work — no direct benefit.

→ Researchers skip metadata steps.



🔄 MetaFold: One-step workflow

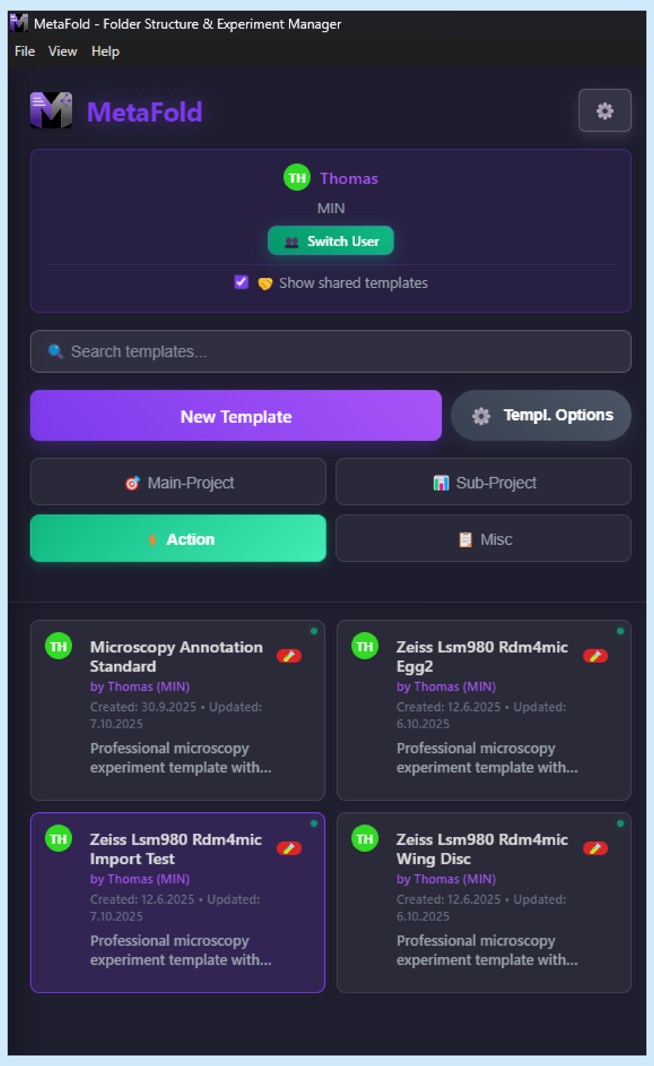


Select Template → Create Folder → Done

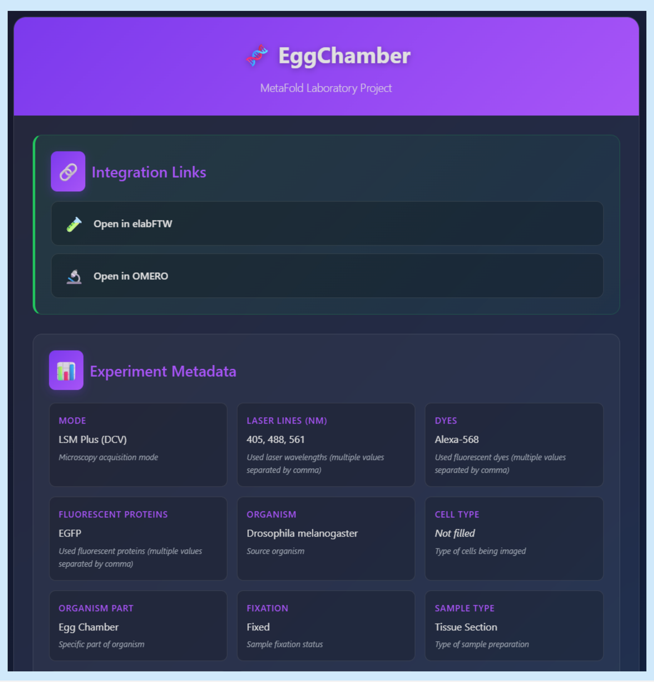
⚙️ Core functions

- 🗂 Template-based creation of project folders and metadata forms
- Category system: customizable templates by project type
- 📄 Predefined metadata with reusable and prefilled consistent entries
- Multi-user and group-level configuration
- 🔗 Direct integrations with elabFTW (ELN) and OMERO
- 🧭 Project discovery: recursive scan and visualization of existing data

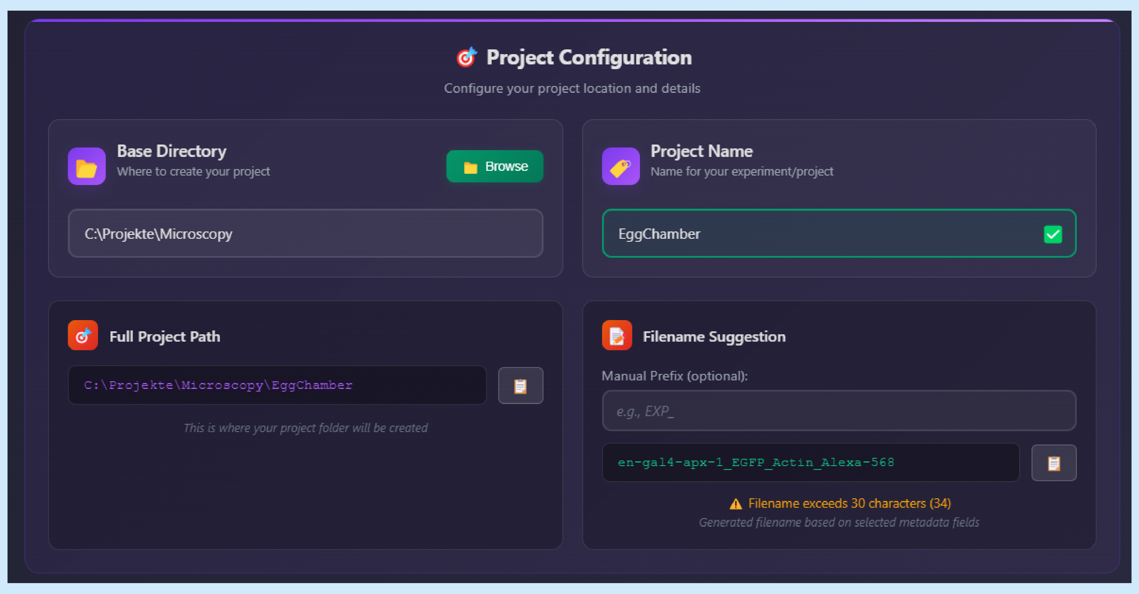
🗂 Templates & Categories



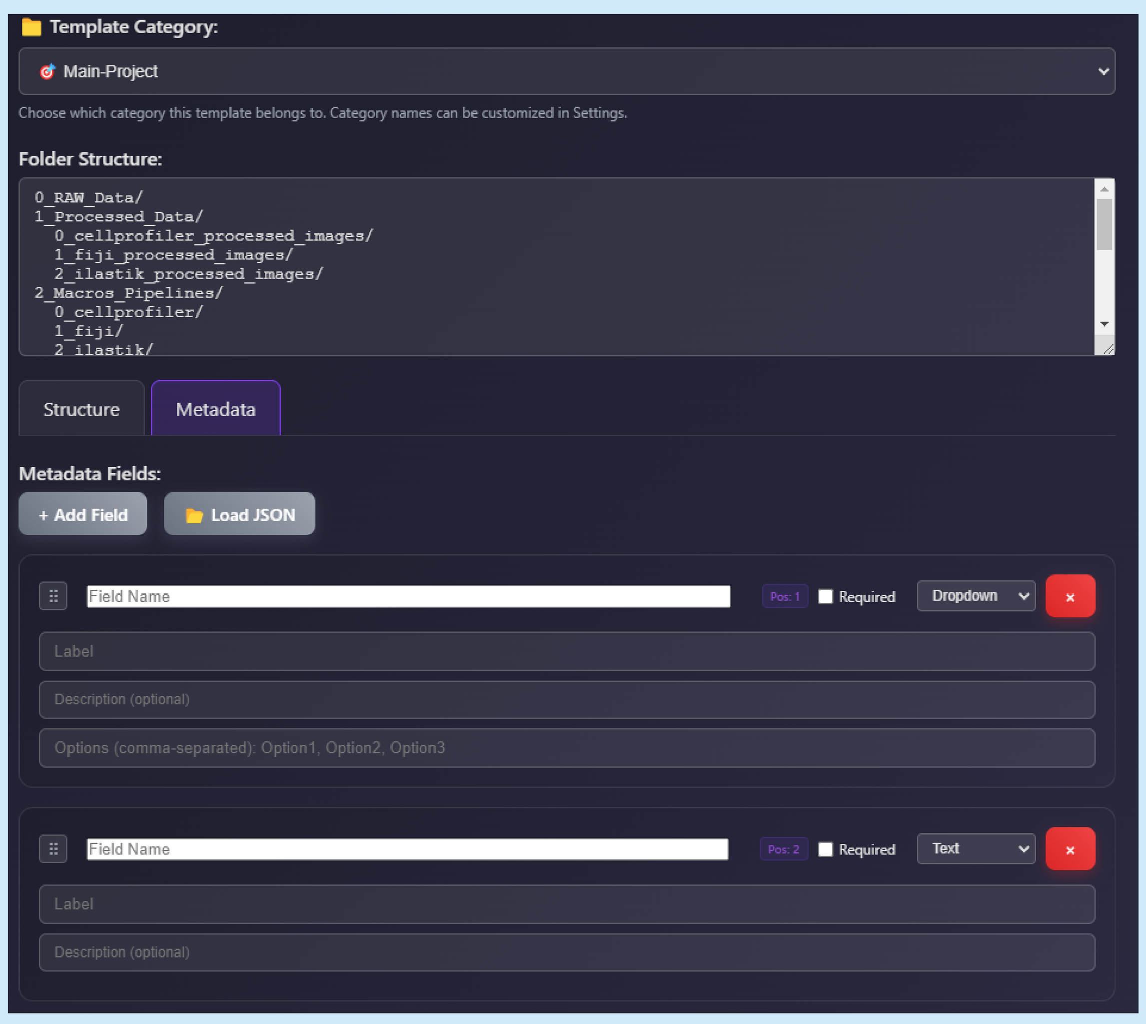
Local metadata.json & Readme.html



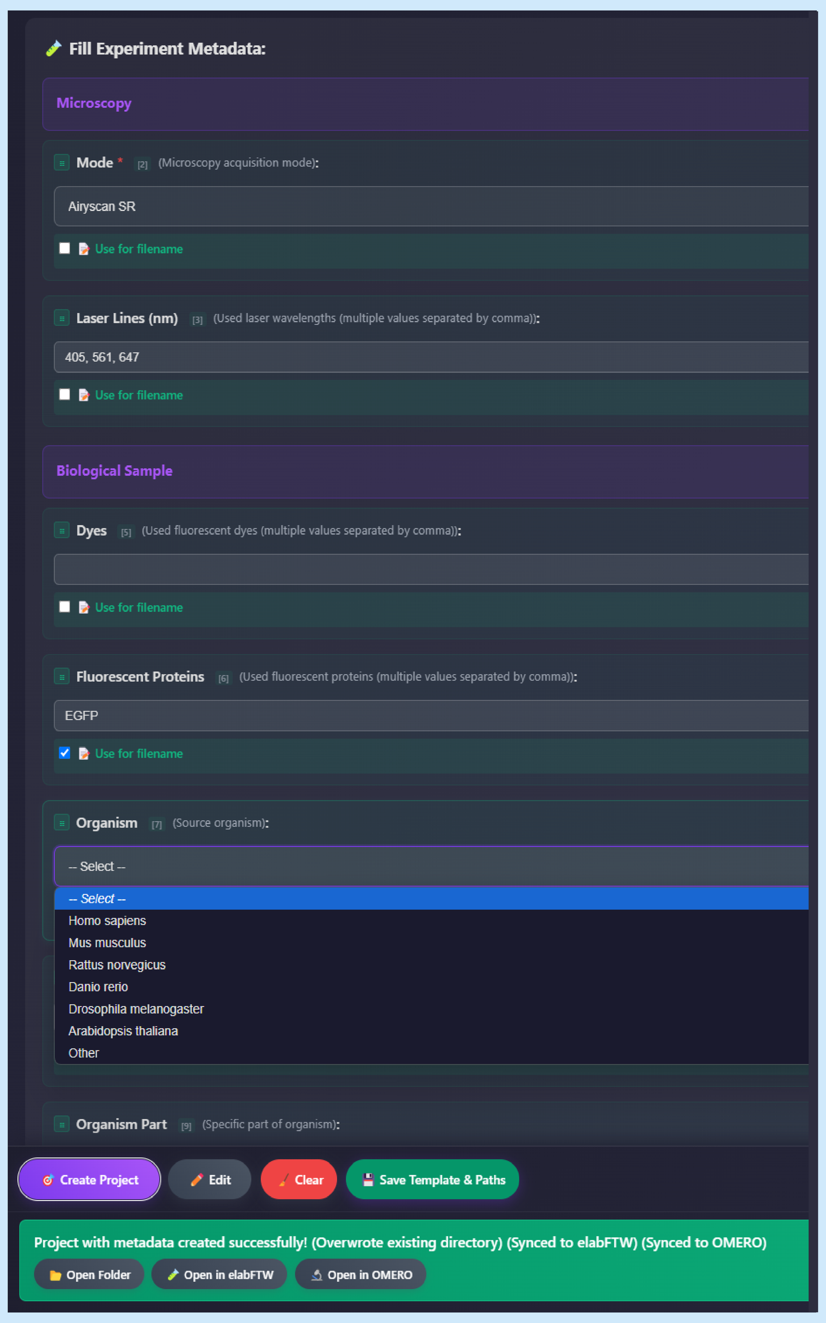
📁 Projects, Folder Structures & Filename Suggestion



Metadata Editor



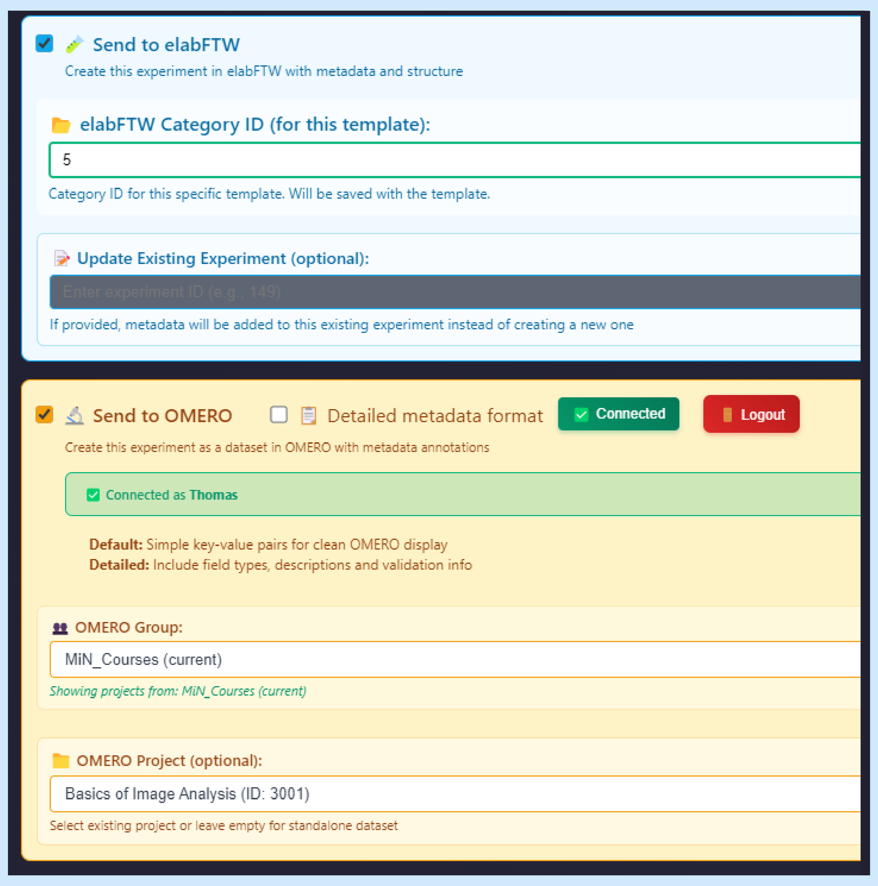
📄 Predefined & Prefilled Metadata Fields

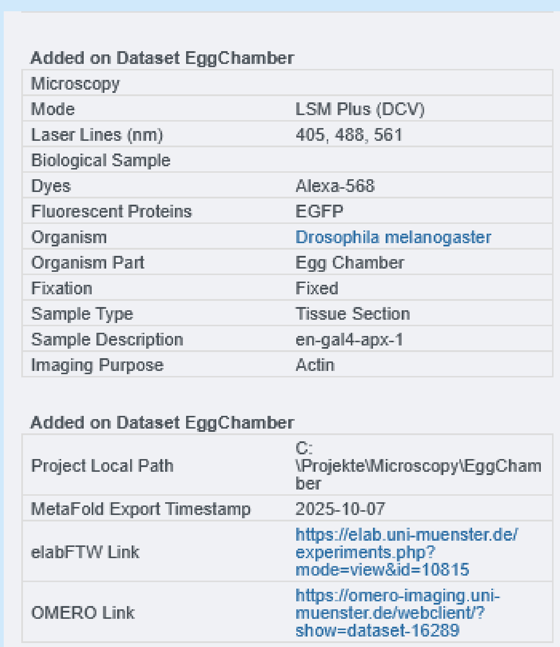


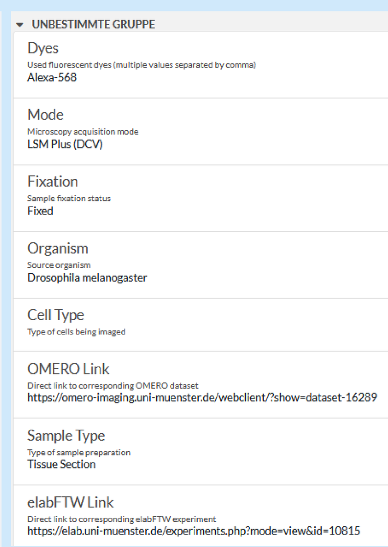
Try it out now

Download MetaFold on GitHub

🔗 Smart Integrations







OMERO

eLabFTW

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